English

Incident 768: ChatGPT Reportedly Implicated in Samsung Data Leak of Source Code and Meeting Notes

Description: Samsung engineers are reported to have inadvertently leaked sensitive company data sometime in March 2023, including source code and internal meeting notes, by using ChatGPT to assist with tasks. ChatGPT allegedly retained the inputted data, leading to a purported breach of confidentiality.

Editor Notes: A note on the timeline: Samsung is reported to have allowed the use of ChatGPT on March 11, 2023, and on March 30th, The Economist (of South Korea) reported that the company had identified at least three incidents of leaked corporate information.

Tools

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Entities

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Alleged: OpenAI and Large language model developers developed an AI system deployed by Samsung engineers and Samsung, which harmed Samsung and Privacy.

Alleged implicated AI systems: ChatGPT, Chatbots and Large language models

Incident Stats

Incident ID	768
Report Count	1

Collapse

Incident Date	2023-03-11
Editors	Daniel Atherton
Applied Taxonomies	MIT

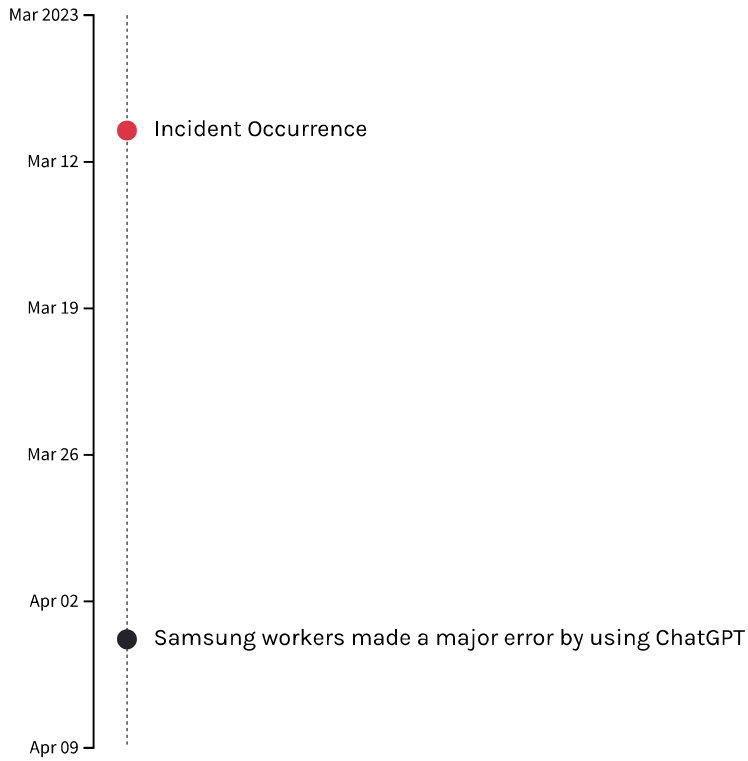
MIT Taxonomy Classifications

Machine-Classified Taxonomy Details

Risk Subdomain
2.1. Compromise of privacy by obtaining, leaking or correctly inferring sensitive information
Risk Domain
Privacy & Security
Entity
Human
Timing
Post-deployment
Intent
Unintentional

Incident Reports

Reports Timeline





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Samsung workers made a major error by using ChatGPT

techradar.com · 2023

Samsung workers have unwittingly leaked top secret data whilst using ChatGPT to help them with tasks.

The company allowed engineers at its semiconductor arm to use the AI writer to help fix problems with their source code. But in doing so, the workers inputted confidential data, such as the source code itself for a new program, internal meeting notes data relating to their hardware.

The upshot is that in just under a month, there were three recorded incidences of employees leaking sensitive information via ChatGPT. Since ChatGPT retains user input data to further train itself, these trade secrets from Samsung are now effectively in the hands of OpenAI, the company behind the AI service.

Out in the OpenAI

In response, Samsung Semiconductor is now developing its own inhouse AI for internal use by employees, but they can only use prompts that are limited to 1024 bytes in size.

In one of the aforementioned cases, an employee asked ChatGPT to optimize test sequences for identifying faults in chips, which is confidential - however, making this process as efficient as possible has the potential to save chip firms considerable time in testing and verifying processors, leading to reductions in cost too.

In another case, an employee used ChatGPT to convert meeting notes into a presentation, the contents of which were obviously not something Samsung would have liked external third parties to have known.

Samsung Electronics sent out a warning to its workers on the potential dangers of leaking confidential information in the wake of the incidences, saying that such data is impossible to retrieve as it is now stored on the servers belonging to OpenAI. In the semiconductor industry, where competition is fierce, any sort of data leak could spell disaster for the company in question.

It doesn't seem as if Samsung has any recourse to request the retrieval or deletion of the sensitive data OpenAI now holds. Some have argued that this very fact makes

the sensitive data OpenAI now holds. Some have argued that this very fact makes ChatGPT non-compliant with the EU's GDPR, as this is one of the core tenants of the law governing how companies collect and use data. It is also one of the reasons why **Italy has now banned the use of ChatGPT nationwide**.

Variants

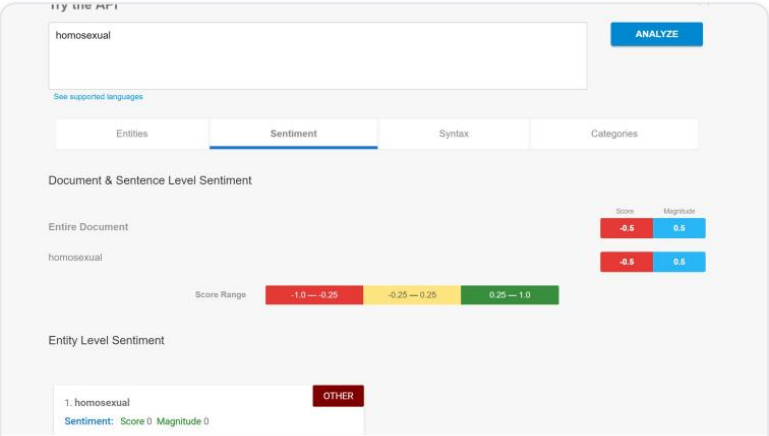
A "variant" is an AI incident similar to a known case—it has the same causes, harms, and AI system. Instead of listing it separately, we group it under the first reported incident. Unlike other incidents, variants do not need to have been reported outside the AIID. Learn more from the research paper.

Seen something similar? Submit a Variant

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By textual similarity

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